

LAAWOL DIGITAL

Website Content Study

What the research says, what the site says, and what it should say

Internal · August 2026

The problem in one sentence

The site's most-read lines — hero, meta description, footer — are **poetic where they should be concrete, and advertise services Laawol does not offer**. A first-time visitor cannot tell, in ten seconds, what they can actually do here.

1 • What the research says

You have ten seconds

Nielsen Norman Group's analysis of over 2 billion page visits found visitors typically leave within 10–20 seconds — unless the page communicates a clear value proposition in the first ten, in which case they often stay minutes. The first screen either answers "what can I do here?" or the visitor is gone.

Concrete beats vague — measurably

Packard & Berger's study of concreteness in customer-facing language found that more concrete wording raised purchase intent by up to **12%** and actual purchases by **13–30%**, across channels and languages. The century-old craft rule agrees — Hopkins (1923): platitudes roll off; specific facts land with full weight.

The working formula

Headline = the concrete end-benefit in one sentence. Subheadline = what you offer, for whom, and what makes it trustworthy. Nothing on the first screen that requires interpretation.

2 • What the best comparable platforms do

PLATFORM	HERO HEADLINE	PATTERN
Taptap Send diaspora remittances	"Send money to Africa, Asia and Latin America"	Verb + object + geography. Zero interpretation needed.
Send My Bag international luggage	"Fast & affordable luggage and box shipping"	Category named plainly; a price-quote form <i>is</i> the subheadline; trust = "20 years · 112,000+ reviews".

Both are diaspora-adjacent, both compete on trust, and neither wastes the headline on brand poetry. The brand feeling lives in second-level copy (Taptap's "Built for the diaspora, by the diaspora") — never in place of the what-we-do statement.

3 • What the site says today — and what's wrong with it

REMOVE Services Laawol does not offer

The boilerplate promises **food, restaurants, home cooks, lawyers, and professional services**. The platform offers none of these — the real catalog is barrel shipping, freight, car sales, car transport, and car parking. This isn't just unclear; a visitor who signs up to find a restaurant discovers the site "lied" to them, and Stanford's web-credibility work is blunt about how fast an overclaim destroys trust. It appears in at least:

- The meta description of the homepage (what Google shows)
- The hero subheadline ("...expédition, voitures, fret, restauration et aide professionnelle")
- The footer boilerplate on **every page** ("...shipping, cars, freight, food, and professional services")
- about.html, app.html, contact.html (... "Cars, barrels, food, and professionals organized together", "Find food", "Find a pro", "African food & restaurants", "home cooks")

REWRITE The hero forces interpretation

"Find the right business for the road home."

It's evocative, but it fails the ten-second test: it names no service, no action, no place. "The road home" only means something once you already know that *Laawol* is Pular for *the road* — which a first-time visitor doesn't.

KEEP — but relocated The tagline itself

"Laawol — the road home." is genuinely good **brand** copy — it's the meaning of the name. It belongs in the footer as a signature, with its story attached, not in the H1 doing the explanatory work it can't do.

DECIDE Shared barrels on services.html

The services page advertises "Barils partagés" while the feature is switched off platform-wide (`sharedBarrelsEnabled`). Either hide the section until launch or mark it "coming soon" — right now it promises a service no customer can request.

4 • Recommended copy

Pattern applied: *verb + concrete services + corridor* in the headline; *who, what, and why trust us* in the subheadline; the brand line as a signed-off footer. French first (site's base language), English via the dictionary as usual.

SLOT	CURRENT	RECOMMENDED
Hero H1	Trouvez la bonne entreprise pour la route vers le pays.	FR: Expédiez des barils, du fret et des voitures entre les États-Unis et l'Afrique de l'Ouest. EN: Ship barrels, freight, and cars between the US and West Africa.
Hero subheadline	...expédition, voitures, fret, restauration et aide professionnelle ...	FR: Laawol est une marketplace d'entreprises inscrites et vérifiées : comparez les prix par baril et par kilo, achetez des voitures vérifiées, demandez des devis de transport et suivez chaque commande — avec l'assistance de la plateforme à chaque étape. EN: Laawol is a marketplace of registered, verified businesses: compare per-barrel and per-kilo prices, buy verified cars, request transport quotes, and track every order — with platform support at every step.
Meta description	...expédition, voitures, fret, restauration et services professionnels ...	FR: Expédition de barils et de fret, achat et transport de voitures, stationnement — par des entreprises inscrites servant la diaspora entre les États-Unis et l'Afrique de l'Ouest. Prix clairs, suivi, assistance. EN: Barrel and freight shipping, car sales, transport, and parking — from registered businesses serving the diaspora between the US and West Africa. Clear prices, tracking, support.
Footer boilerplate (all pages)	...shipping, cars, freight, food, and professional services ...	FR: Une plateforme de confiance pour la diaspora africaine : des entreprises inscrites proposent l'expédition de barils et de fret, la vente, le transport et le stationnement de voitures — avec des prix clairs et un vrai suivi. EN: A trusted platform for the African diaspora: registered businesses offer barrel and freight shipping, car sales, transport, and parking — with clear prices and real tracking.
Footer tagline	Laawol — la route vers le pays.	Keep it, and attach its story: FR: <i>Laawol</i> signifie « le chemin » en pular. Laawol — la route vers le pays. EN: <i>Laawol</i> means "the road" in Pular. Laawol — the road home.

Fictional- service blocks	"Find food", "Find a pro", "African food & restaurants", "home cooks", "A lawyer or professional", "Cars, barrels, food, and professionals..."	Delete everywhere (index, about, app, contact, and the dictionary). If food or professional services ever launch, announce them then — not before.
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Why this works: the headline now passes the ten-second test (verb, services, corridor — Taptap Send's exact pattern), every claim matches a service that actually exists in the app, the concrete price-per-barrel/per-kilo language is the kind shown to lift purchases 13–30%, and the brand poetry keeps its place — explained, in the footer, where it builds identity instead of costing clarity.

5 • If you do only one thing

Remove the fictional services. Unclear copy costs conversions; untrue copy costs trust — and Laawol's entire pitch *is* trust.